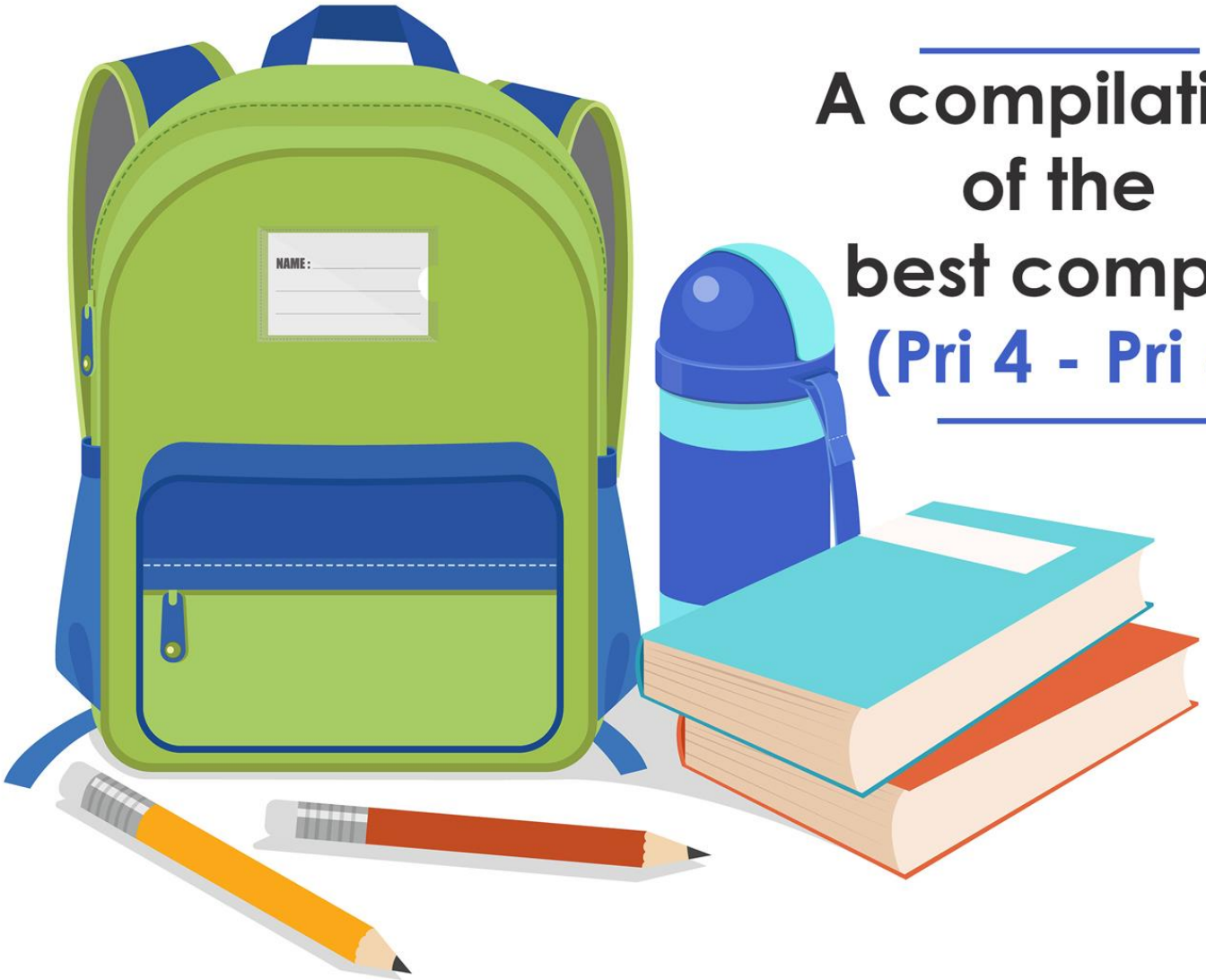
Model Compositions for PRIMARY SCHOOL

A compilation of the best compos (Pri 4 - Pri 6)



Jerry Lee

Acknowledgements

I would like to thank all the students who made this possible. I enjoyed teaching you all and I also enjoyed reading your compositions. Without your contributions, this ebook would not be possible. We are really grateful that you've shared your work with other students in Singapore.

Contents

A note to Parents and Students Reading this: 5
How to use this Ebook? 5
"Help my child can't write!" 6
How Can Your Child Learn Creative Writing? 7
1. Learn online in the Creative Writing Master Class 7
2. Learn at my tuition centres – Grade Solution Learning Centre 9
Terms and Conditions 10
Topic: Regret 11
Pictures given: A dustbin, A glass of water with ice-cubes in it, A capsule. 11
Topic: Trying Something New 13
Pictures given: Rock Climbing, Snorkelling Gear, Apron 13
Topic: Trying Something New 15
Pictures given: Rock Climbing, Snorkelling Gear, Apron 15
Topic: A Dilemma 17
Pictures given: A student copying answers, a result slip marked 'F', a door with the label 'Principal's office' 17
Topic: A Dilemma 19
Pictures given: A student copying answers, a result slip marked 'F', a door with the label 'Principal's office' 19
Topic: Greed 21
Pictures given: A variety of fried food, a toilet sign, digestive aid juice 21
Topic: A Person in Need of Help / Bravery / Courage 23
Pictures given: A drowning boy, an umbrella, a fire extinguisher 23
Topic: Bravery / Courage 25
Pictures given: A zebra crossing, an arm in a cast, cyclists 25
Topic: A Challenge 27
Pictures given: Athletes running, A Racket and a Shuttlecock, a plaster 27
Topic: Teamwork 29
Pictures given: A soccer ball, a dragon boat, paintbrush and paint 29
Topic: Teamwork 32
Pictures given: A soccer ball, a dragon boat, paintbrush and paint 32
Topic: An Unexpected Incident 34
Pictures given: A dog, A skateboard, An open lock 34
Topic: An Unexpected Incident 36
Pictures given: A dog, A skateboard, An open lock 36

Topic: An Act of Kindness 38
Pictures given: An old lady, An MRT train, "Priority Seat" sign 38
Topic: Being Kind 40
Pictures given: A plaster, A wheelchair, Baby birds in a nest 40
Topic: Helping Someone Out 41
Pictures given: A wallet, A Crying boy, a "For Disabled" toilet sign 41
Topic: Charity 43
Pictures given: A donation tin, Children organising a food drive, A car wash 43
Topic: Charity 45
Pictures given: A donation tin, Children organising a food drive, A car wash 45
Topic: Overcoming Fear 47
Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage 47
Topic: Overcoming Fear 49
Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage 49
Topic: Overcoming Fear 50
Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage 50
Topic: Overcoming Fear 51
Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage 51
Topic: Overcoming Fear 53
Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage 53
Topic: First Day in School 55
Pictures given: A bus, Children raising their hands, A boy clutching his stomach 55
Topic: Resilience 57
Pictures given: A running track, A glass of water, A light bulb 57
Some Final Words 59
You might find these online courses helpful! 60

A note to Parents and Students Reading this:

Hi there, I am Jerry Lee, the founder of the creative writing website www.writingsamurai.com. I am also the director of Grade Solution Learning Centre, a humble little tuition chain. We currently have branches at Bugis, Kovan, and Clementi.

Over the years, I have taught hundreds of students English and Creative Writing. I have collected and compiled some of the better compos I have received from these students into this ebook.

These compos have been edited and the mistakes have been corrected. Some sentences or phrases have also been reworded to narrate the story better. However, I can assure you that most of the words or phrases were written by the students themselves.

*(If you spot any mistakes, kindly drop me an email showing me where the mistake is made so that I can rectify immediately.)

This compilation is still growing. But don't worry, if you are in my email list you will be informed when I've released version 2, version 3 or version 4 of this ebook. Hopefully each version will contain more topics, and more awesome compos that you can refer to.

How to use this Ebook?

Let me start by telling you what you should not do:

1. Do not memorise or copy these compos for your exams. (That's not only cheating but also a waste of your brain space. Trust me, there are easier ways to learn creative writing.)
2. Do not memorise good expressions, phrases, idioms or vocabulary without understanding the meaning and the context. You can't just cut and paste phrases, and hope to score.
3. Do not copy these compos for your homework. You are only cheating yourself from actual learning. You won't gain intelligence by doing so, and in fact, you may actually become lazier… and dumber.

What you should do:

1. Appreciate and enjoy the stories written by these good kids.
2. Learn and research on the good expressions you see in these compos. Understand how the expression can be used in the **right context**.
3. Good expressions aren't the key to scoring high marks. Learn how these students make use of sentence structures, 'power words', paragraphing, dialogue, description… and many other aspects of creative writing to fully engage the reader.

"Help my child can't write!"

After reading this book or going through some of my free learning videos, some of you may be thinking of asking me to tutor or coach your child. (For your info, sorry I don't do 1-1 home tuition.) However, you are more than welcome to enrol your child in my online courses or at my tuition centres (if you manage to find a vacancy).

Here are some things you should consider before engaging me:

- I am against the use of pompous, bombastic words that serve no purpose. Instead I teach students how to use the right word for the right situation and the right context… which can be plain and simple at times.

- I am against long, drawn-out sentences that dilute the emphasis of a key point or message. Instead I teach students how to vary their sentences accordingly for 'flow' and effect.

- I am against memorising expressions and regurgitating them during exams. Instead I urge students to understand the meaning and context such expressions can be used. Even better, I guide students to come up with their own unique expressions.

- I am against 'writing to sound smart'. Instead I urge students to always keep the reader in mind while writing. If you can say something in less words, say it in less words.

- I can't guarantee instant improvements. But if your child goes through my lessons, does each assignment religiously and apply everything he or she learns, over time, you will definitely see an overall improvement in his or her writing skills.

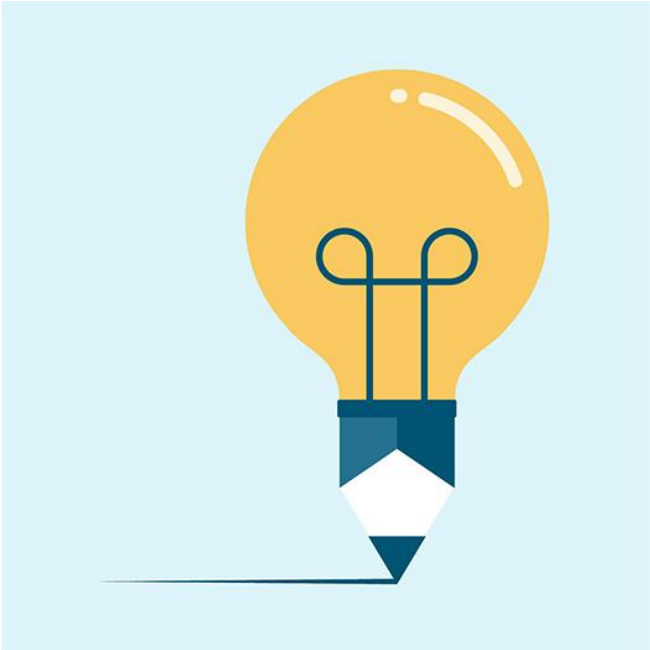
- I don't entertain refunds. I believe my time is better spent teaching your child than transferring money back and forth. If you want to get a feel of my teaching, you are more than welcome to enrol for my free online courses or claim your 30 day free trial of the Creative Writing Master Class. You can also read all these model compositions or these other useful blog posts on my website: http://writingsamurai.com/blog/

  I believe these resources are more than enough to help you make an informed buying decision.

How Can Your Child Learn Creative Writing?

There are 2 ways your child can learn with me.

1. Learn online in the Creative Writing Master Class



If you stay too far from my centre…

If you don't like noisy classrooms…

If you are able to make your child stick to a fixed online-learning schedule…

Sign up for the Creative Writing Master Class!

What is this Course About?
This is a premium online Creative Writing Course that teaches and trains your child to write effective compositions.

How Does this Course Work?
For the Master Class, students will learn by watching video lessons.
Then, they have to complete a variety of writing assignments and submit them to us via email.

Students will have access to new lessons every 7 days.

Here are some lessons they will learn:
- How to write introductions
- How to use repetition for the utmost effect
- Sentence Structure Variation
- How to Describe Character, Setting, Object, Action

- How to use Dialogue effectively
- How to write the Resolution and Conclusion
- How to use Good Phrases

How can my child submit assignments for review?
- email me, microsoft word, scan, pdf file.
- take a clear photo and email it to me.

My team and I will mark your work, give you feedback, and teach you how to improve. Master Class students are my highest priority students.

Who SHOULD join this course?
- P5 and P6 students
- P4 students can join if their overall English marks is above 80/100
- Students who are serious about improving their grades
- Students who want to see "miracle" results happening to them
- Students who are willing to put in some hard work

How Long is this Course?
- 10 months
- Anytime you feel that you have learnt enough, you can just unsubscribe.

Sounds good! Can I try?
Yes, you can. The Creative Writing Master Class comes with a **30 day RISK-FREE Trial.** Your credit card will not be charged for the first 30 days. You've got nothing to lose!

2. Learn at my tuition centres – Grade Solution Learning Centre

If your child needs lots of nagging, motivation, and lots of pushing…

If you don't mind travelling to Hougang or Bugis…

If you don't mind slightly rowdy classes…

Then you are welcomed to enrol your child at Grade Solution Learning Centre! However, the spaces are limited and you are likely to be placed on a waitlist for a few months. We have 3 outlets – **Bugis**, **Kovan, and Clementi**.

My experienced tutors and I do teach other classes as well. (From Primary 3 all the way till Junior College). We specialise in English, Math and Science subjects.

You can find out more details by clicking the link below:

https://gradesolution.com.sg/schedule/

Terms and Conditions

This free ebook is under the property of Writing Samurai Pte Ltd. You are not allowed to republish any of the compositions here for commercial purposes without seeking consent from the company. This ebook is made free for the benefit of students.

Please use it ethically and feel free to share the love!

Now go ahead and enjoy these compos ☺

Topic: Regret

Pictures given: A dustbin, A glass of water with ice-cubes in it, A capsule.

I almost did not recognise the face in the mirror. My skin had turned yellowish-white. Thin foamy lines of spittle trailed from my cracked lips. My eyes had sunk into their sockets, their previously radiant glow replaced by a dull, lifeless shimmer.

Something was wrong. I could feel it in my bones.

I was fine just a few hours ago. But now, I felt rotten to the core. There was no time to lose. I knew I needed urgent medical help.

As I fumbled desperately for my mobile phone in my trouser pocket, my eyes fell on the glass of chilled water on the table. Subconsciously, I lunged for it, and grabbed it with my trembling hand.

Was this the culprit?

This was a burning question in my head as I cast an accusing look at its contents. The water in the glass seemed so innocent, swirling about nonchalantly among the ice cubes.

Why on earth had I drunk the water?

"This place is not Singapore, son. Don't drink the water here unless it has been boiled," Uncle Ben had cautioned me.

However, ever since arriving in Bangkok five days ago to stay with Uncle Ben for the December holidays, I had always seen him guzzle tap water without falling sick. If Uncle Ben could do it, why could I not?

The very next moment, I felt my stomach throb with excruciating pain.

"Aaah!" I groaned. As I bent over in pain, the glass in my hand slipped from my grip.

Thud! Landing on the floor, the glass rolled to the left before coming to a quivering stop, spilling out the water and the ice cubes.

My body was now shaking, and my stomach was churning violently.

I groaned again, louder this time. I was clutching my stomach.

Why did I ever drink the water? Alas! It was no use regretting now! As my knees gave way, I collapsed to the floor like a crumpled doll.

"Jake!" a voice called out.

In the hazy background, I could barely make out the faint silhouette of a fast-approaching man. A pair of strong hands grabbed me by my shoulders. Then, darkness descended and everything turned black…

When I opened my eyes, I found myself in a hospital bed.

"Jake! Thank goodness you're finally awake! You have been unconscious for the past two days!" It was Uncle Ben. He reached out and clasped my hands tightly.

"What…hap…happened? Was it… the… wat..water?" I asked feebly.

Dr Philips shook his head and said, "No, not really. Drinking unboiled water sometimes gives you a stomach ache, especially if your body is not used to the local conditions here. But it definitely won't cause to collapse and almost die."

Uncle Ben chipped in, "It was the fat-burning capsules you took. I found them on your bedside table and passed them to Dr Philips."

"Yes! Thanks to your uncle, we're able to diagnose your condition and quickly treat you. Those capsules were dangerous! Where did you buy them?" Dr Philips asked.

"Do you mean the red and yellow capsules?" I asked as memories came flooding back. I had gone to Chatuchak market, a shopping haven in Bangkok. I had stopped at numerous "weight-loss" stalls here, hoping to find a cheap, miracle cure for my obesity. I was convinced to buy two boxes of "Instant Fat Buster" capsules. I had consumed two capsules there and then.

Dr Philips nodded. "Yes, laboratory tests have shown that those capsules contain traces of dangerous toxins. You're one lucky chap, young man! You could have died!"

I lowered my eyes, deeply regretting my naivety. Hugging Uncle Ben tightly, I started weeping. In some aspects of life, there are just no shortcuts. I had learnt my lesson.

By Ajay, Primary 6 2016

Topic: Trying Something New

Pictures given: Rock Climbing, Snorkelling Gear, Apron

Mr Jimmy was getting tired of teaching because the primary six group was so naughty. Even in the holidays he got no rest. One day his patience snapped!

Mr Jimmy declared, "I will not write nor teach any more because it is making my blood pressure go up. I can hardly take a break. I want to follow my dream of becoming a baker!"

So he went off and baked a delicious lava cake to soothe his feelings.

Mr Jimmy was determined to open a shop to sell his cakes. So he gathered all his savings and rented a space which he named "Jimmy's Baked Treats". He searched Google for the best cake and biscuit recipes, but he was unable to attract enough customers for his desserts. He was becoming desperate.

So Mr Jimmy made name cards, listing his cakes and his contact number. He spent days dropping his cards into the letter-boxes of all the houses and flats near his shop, and wherever he went. One week of silence, two quiet weeks, then on Monday… Brrrrring! Brrrrring! He got a call.

"Er, Jimmy's Baked Treats, how may I help you?"

"Can I order three strawberry cakes, two peach cakes, six hazelnut sprinkle cakes and a fudge chocolate cake," the caller said.

What a huge order! Mr Jimmy was overjoyed. "Of course! That's twelve cakes, so the total, including delivery, is eight hundred dollars."

The caller grunted, then said, "Okay, I want them in seven days," and he gave an address that was about one kilometre away.

"I'm made! I'm riiiiiich," Mr Jimmy sang as he began working on the cakes.

A week later, Mr Jimmy used a trolley to trundle the cakes to the house. When the customer (a big beefy man) saw the cakes, he was surprised that the strawberry cake was actually a sponge cake with jam on it. He got annoyed that the peach was another sponge cake with peach jam, and that the hazelnut was a pound cake with a Nutella spread. He hollered at Mr Jimmy, "These are cheap cakes! Take them back! I will not pay you!" He picked up a strawberry cake and smashed it in Mr Jimmy's face.

Poor Mr Jimmy felt so humiliated that he did not leave his home for a week. He did a lot of thinking, and decided that he was not cut out to be a baker. “I think I should stick to teaching. Even if the students are frightful, cheeky monkeys, at least they will not rub my face in cake.”

And that is how Mr Jimmy ended up in Intellicat Tuition School.

By Benjamin Ng, Primary 5

Topic: Trying Something New

Pictures given: Rock Climbing, Snorkelling Gear, Apron

I strapped on the harness and wriggled my fingers into the gloves. I fought the urge to run away from this rock wall. “No, I cannot chicken out now I thought firmly. I was regretting having accepted the challenge. It was like riding that really high roller coaster again.

At the age of seven, I was tall enough for roller-coaster rides. My confident cousin dragged me to the highest roller-coaster ride available in the theme park. From afar, the roller-coaster looked like an earthworm. As I approached it, the whole thing grew bigger until, close up, it was enormous. The view from the top would have been stunning if I were not riding the roller-coaster. Instead, I was stunned by fear. Since then I have never liked being up high and have kept my feet firmly on the ground.

“You can do it,” I encouraged myself repeatedly.

One, two, three steps. I pushed myself up to reach the first hand-hold. Slowly I reached for the next stone, and the next. Soon my palms became moist and tiny droplets of sweat formed on my forehead. After what seemed like forever, I looked down. I was only a few metres off the ground! I wondered how long it would take for me to reach the top. As I climbed, my anxiety increased.

I got to a point where I was stuck. I hung on to two stones for dear life, while my were feet scrabbling for a resting place. Even though there was the harness, I had my “what if” moment. I struggled to feel for a toehold. Without thinking, I did the last thing a faint-hearted rock-climber should do — I looked down. I winced. The ground looked hundreds of meters down. I imagined I saw clouds beneath my feet.

“Help!” I shouted desperately.

“Don’t worry, boy. I’m here to help you,” a welcome voice rang in my ears.

I looked up. A trainer was a few metres above me. He had a harness strapped around him and had lowered himself down. He guided my feet to the holds I had to step on. Then he pointed to the rocks I was to grip hold of. Rock by rock, I climbed up. Finally I reached the top. The scenery, and my relief, was amazing.

“Thank you! Oh thank you! I could not have done it without you!" I told my saviour gratefully.

The trainer smiled and said, “This is what I enjoy doing.”

Together, we sat and watched the sunset.

This achievement gave me confidence in myself. I could not believe that I had overcome the fear that had haunted me for years. In life, we cannot control some things. However, fears can be controlled and overcome if we put in some effort.

By Natalie Chua, Primary 6

Topic: A Dilemma

Pictures given: A student copying answers, a result slip marked 'F', a door with the label 'Principal's office'

Never.

Never had I known it would turn out this way. Agony coalesced into stream of tears that trickled down my cheeks. I felt a stinging pain on my fleshy folds. Never had I known I would get into this. Never.

It all happened like this.

I was too smart for my own good. Everyone called me "Google Brainz". But all this came to an end when I became too arrogant and mixed with "good" friends. Or so I thought.

I began to steal things, beat people up and do things that a normal person would not do. I performed such deeds under peer pressure. I would follow my friends and we would do horrible things that now, being a mature boy, I truly regret. Maybe I just wanted to be accepted by my peers. I also never studied from that day on. I did not think of the consequences of my actions.

My parents wanted to put a stop to my wrong-doings. They scolded me all the time. The relationship between my parents and me got worse and I never came home.

Then my father got a heart attack and he went back to his Creator.

I was grief-stricken. I decided to turn over a new leaf. Never had I known he would die so suddenly. His last words were "Baptist, please be a better boy." His words kept ringing in my head.

That was before my exams. I left my group of friends, and I tried my best to be good. I studied hard, but there was too much to catch up with my class. I tried my best. I wanted to make my mother proud and show her that "Google Brainz" had come back.

In a blink of an eye, the exams came. I was not prepared.

"Your time starts now!"

I did the paper. It seemed like a piece of cake but towards the end, the questions that were thrown at me were too difficult. Then I counted how many marks I would lose. I would get 90 if I got all correct. An evil thought entered my mind – just copy! If I were to get an "A-star", I would need to get 91 marks. Copy! Then, my father's last words to me resounded in my head. I shook my head. I must be a good boy. I was trying so hard, but the dark side took over me.

Copy Baptist!

No!

Just copy!

It was a dilemma.

I looked around. Everyone was doing their work, and the invigilator was looking at my other classmates. The classroom was as silent as a grave. Should I?

"You have 10 minutes left. Please check your work."

At that moment, I made up my mind. I peered at Jill's paper.

"Teacher! Baptist is copying my answers!" Jill shouted

The invigilator marched up to me immediately. I was doomed!

"Mr Lim!" he boomed.

Oh no! I am as good as dead meat. Great job Jill, I thought to myself. My mother was informed.

"Piak!" the cane came down hard and pain spread through my fleshy folds. It was intolerable.

Never.

Never had I known I would get punished. I was trying to be good. Tears continued to trickle down my cheeks. Never had I known that a dilemma would get me into this. Never.

By Baptist Lim, Primary 6

Topic: A Dilemma

Pictures given: A student copying answers, a result slip marked 'F', a door with the label 'Principal's office'

Tension filled the hall; numerous eyes bored down their examination papers and brows were furrowed in deep concentration. The hall was silent and you could hear the scribbling of answers down on the test paper. The clickety-clack of the examiner's heels could be heard as she walked down the rows invigilating. Her razor sharp eyes tracked down every move, not letting anything pass.

I stared regretfully at the blank paper before me; a bitter taste of defeat punched me in my guts as answers failed to come to my mind. I did not study at all. When the time was up I handed in the paper and prayed for the best.

A few months later, it was the day that our results were released.

"Class, today, I will be revealing all your marks for your PSLE (Primary School Leaving Examination) Science paper," Mr Tan, our form teacher said.

I had not slept well the whole night. My heart thumped profusely against my ribs. I looked around and saw that everyone in the classroom also had worried looks plastered all over their faces. Mr Tan called for us to collect our test papers.

"Tom!"

As I heard my name being called, I stood up from my desk and walked briskly to Mr Tan. In my mind, I imagined that I had scored 90 marks. But to my horror, when I looked down at my paper, I saw that I had only scored 69 marks. I was speechless and stood rooted to the ground. I rubbed my eyes to make sure I was not seeing things.

The world came crashing down when I learnt that I had scored 69 marks for my PSLE Science paper. I tried to swallow the bitterness in my throat and ignore the dismay that swept through me at that realisation. At the same instant, I imagined hearing my mother's heart shattering into a thousand pieces. It would be devastating news to her, as she had pinned all hopes on me.

Suddenly, a thought came into my mind. Should I change the marks to 96? Or should I just be honest? I pondered a while more and decided to change the marks to 96 and after my mother had signed the paper, I could just easily change it back to 69.

When I went home that day, I tool out my correction tape and taped it over the marks. I changed it to 96. Then I went to ask my mother to sign the paper. Little did I know that my mother would check through the paper.

"Tom? Why is it that you can get 96 marks yet you have so many mistakes?"

"I…I…"

I was speechless. I decided to tell her the truth. She told me that cheating would not help solve any problems and that we should be honest. Unable to contain my grief, I buried my face into my palms and wept uncontrollably.

As the saying goes, "Honesty is the best policy." I have learnt that being honest is the best thing you can do. From this experience I realised that we should not do things that go against our conscience. I would never perform such a silly act again.

By Kylia, Primary 5

Topic: Greed

Pictures given: A variety of fried food, a toilet sign, digestive aid juice

"Ugh…" I groaned weakly. I had lost it. It was just 24 hours before "the day" and I blew the opportunity. All this was because of my greed. The greed for a delicious taste and a fulfilling meal. I groaned and lay on my bed wondering whether that moment of greed was really worth it. Images of the fateful day flashed in my mind like the scenes of a horror movie…

It was the day before my school sports meet. I was taking part in a 100 metre race and had trained hard for it. I wanted to prove to the whole school that I was the fastest. Soon, the school will find out about my talent, I thought with pride. I had waited very long for this sports event. But before I retired for the day, I had to get dinner.

My parents were at work and I would not be seeing them until tomorrow. As they were not at home to cook food for me, they told me to go to the nearby hawker centre to have dinner. When I heard those words, I was filled with happiness. I was hoping to try out food at the newest stall: "Mr Chan's Fried Delicacies. However, my happiness was quashed when my parents said that I had to eat healthy food and not "unhealthy food from unhealthy stalls".

When I reached the hawker centre, it was already bustling with people. The noise of patrons shouting orders to stallholders was drowned out by the deafening clang of plates and cutlery. The aroma of the delicious food enticed me. I made my way towards "Mr Tan's Healthy Meals" and got into the queue. But greed and temptation got the better of me.

"Mum and Dad are not at home. They would never know if I ate from Mr Chan's store or Mr Tan's store", I thought.

I felt a surge of conflicting emotions. Should I disobey my parents and eat from Mr Chan's Fried Delicacies or should I follow what my parent's advice and eat from Mr Tan's Healthy Food store? My parent's trust in me would be shattered but I would have a satisfying meal. Imagining the taste of Mr Chan's Fried delicacies, I gave in to my greed. I immediately stepped out from the queue and headed over to Mr Chan's shop.

Mr Chan's shop was not that clean. There were flies flying around and he wore a stained t-shirt with multiple patches. He had no gloves and the kitchen was dripping with Tom Yam Soup. However, I ignored the misgivings and put my stomach in charge and ordered as much as I could. With my plate piled up with food, I began devouring them up in record speed. The colourful flavours danced on my taste buds leaving me craving for more. Within an hour, I had finished my meal and I made my way home. Little did I know I was going to experience the result of my greed

The next morning, I woke up with a terrible sensation. It felt as if my stomach was on fire. It was so painful I could not get out of bed. My parents immediately phoned the doctor

who came as quickly as he could. After a thorough examination, he asked, “Did you eat something unhealthy yesterday?”

I thought of saying no, but the pain in my stomach was too overwhelming. I told them the truth.

The doctor immediately said, “You have food poisoning. You would have to rest for few days and drink plenty of this digestive aid juice.”

After the doctor left, my parents chided me for what had happened. I had missed the chance of proving myself in the 100 metre race event that I had been training for diligently because of my greed. My parents then comforted me and said that I could work for the next term exam. I nodded glumly.

So here I am in bed, resting. From this incident I could draw two conclusions. One, greed can ruin opportunities that you have waited so long for. Two, “Mr Tan’s Healthy Meals” is much better than digestive aid juice.

By Anonymous, Primary 6

Topic: A Person in Need of Help / Bravery / Courage

Pictures given: A drowning boy, an umbrella, a fire extinguisher

Fear was pulsating through my entire being as I tried against all odds to get to the head bobbing up and down in the churning waters. Fear Desperation. Agony. However, I vowed to save him. I had to…

Before all this turmoil had happened, I was having relaxing time by the beach. There were a few families there too. Children were squealing and bikers were whizzing by. Palm trees swayed gently in the wind as the smell of the sea invigorated me. It was just what I had in mind when I decided to go the beach for a break.

Suddenly, a high-pitched whistle snapped me out of my tranquility and shattered the joyful atmosphere. The lifeguard was blowing his whistle to warn everyone of an impending storm.

The sky had darkened ominously; it was full of dark grey clouds. Thunder rumbled in the distance. Without warning, a curtain of rain beat down from the sky. The waves turned choppy, a stark contrast to the serene waters before.

All hell broke loose as everyone scrambled back to shore to seek shelter. “A ruined holiday,” I grumbled inwardly.

Just as I was about to seek shelter in a nearby restaurant, I heard it.

“Help!” A small voice called out. I looked out into the sea but nothing seemed amiss. Perhaps my ears were playing tricks on me. I shrugged and turned back.

Then, I heard the cry of help again. This time, it was louder. I turned around instinctively and a horrible sight greeted me.

A small figure was struggling in the choppy waves. His head bobbed up and down as the waves closed in on him, seeming to hold him hostage.

My heart was thumping furiously as I looked around frantically. Not a single soul was in sight. Not even the lifeguard! Everyone must have already taken shelter.

I contemplated calling for help but every second was precious. It was a matter of life and death. The poor boy seemed to be drifting further away from the shore. He was going to drown soon.

Remembering my mother’s mantra to help others who are in need, I decided to save the boy on my own. I could not bear to see him drown before my eyes! I had to do something!

Taking a deep breath to calm my nerves, I plunged into the icy cold waters. The waters felt like it wanted pull me down into its deathly grasp too. I swam in powerful strokes towards the boy, vowing to myself that I would save him.

It was tough to swim against the currents but I persevered. Every time I swam closer to the boy, the current would push me back again. My legs ached. My arms were tired. But my spirit was determined. I had to save him. I had to.

My perseverance finally paid off. I summoned my last ounce of energy and swarm towards the boy who was already faltering.

Without hesitation, I pulled him into my arms and with a spark of hope in me, I swam back to shore.

A lone figure stood on the shore - the boy's mother. When we finally reached the shore, I felt a surge of relief. Overwhelmed with fatigue, I collapsed onto the ground.

Reunited with his mother, the boy hugged her tightly as tears of joy streamed down their cheeks. Turning to me, the boy's mother thanked me copiously for saving her son. Although I was dripping wet, I glowed with warmth. I had performed a courageous act.

By Clar, Primary 6

Topic: Bravery / Courage

Pictures given: A zebra crossing, an arm in a cast, cyclists

"Bye Mom!" I said as I left the house.

"Stay safe!" my mother replied.

I headed to school with a smile on my face. Along the way, I saw Alex and Mary. We chatted and soon lost track of time. I checked my watch and to my horror, we were late.

"Run! We are late for school!" I shouted.

I dashed while Alex and Mary cycled as fast as they could. Ahead of us was a zebra-crossing.

"Stop! There is a zebra crossing up ahead!" I shouted but they chose to ignore my warnings and carried on cycling.

I saw a car driving at high speed towards the zebra crossing. At this moment it was like the whole world stopped and I only heard my heart palpitating. I thought, my friends or me? In that moment, I made my decision.

While they were cycling on the zebra crossing and with the speeding car less than a metre away, I lunged forward and pushed my friends aside. I felt heroic till the excruciating pain came when the car crashed into me and sent me flying. At that moment, I looked up at the blue sky and wondered if I would survive. When I landed on the ground, I became unconscious.

I woke up and I was told by my doctor from the hospital that I had been unconscious for two months. When I was about to thank the doctor for saving me, I was shocked as I could not move my legs. I was dazed and saw my parents crying outside of the room.

"What happened, doctor?" I muttered.

"You are paralysed waist-down from your injuries. I am sorry to tell you that this is permanent," the doctor said.

"Is there any way to cure this?" I asked with the least hope I had.

"Sorry there is no cure. I have tried my best," the doctor replied.

I cried my eyes out. I felt a tinge of regret for act of bravery or folly. Alex and Mary showed up the next day and told me that they were grateful for what I had done. They consoled me and I felt motivated to carry on my life again.

When I was discharged, I went to school the next day in my wheelchair. I was invited to the principal's office. The principal praised me and decided to present me an award for my act of bravery during the assembly talk. During the assembly talk, the principal gave a

speech on road safety. Then he commended on my bravery and welcomed me up onto the stage to receive my award. The students even stood up and applauded for me. I received the award and felt so happy that I had made the right decision.

By Derrick, Primary 6

Topic: A Challenge

Pictures given: Athletes running, A Racket and a Shuttlecock, a plaster

In all my years of coaching, I have never seen a runner like Bolt. I am sure you have heard of him. He is a legend and may he always remain a legend. This is his story.

Bolt was once racing with his friends for fun, but he came in last. All his friends laughed at him. At first, he let it slide. The next day, his friends were treating him like a loser. It continued for too long and soon he could not take it. In his position, most people would have snapped and become depressed. Bolt, however, channelled his anger into something more productive. He started training to run faster and faster. That was how he met me.

Bolt met me when I was training myself (being a coach and all). I met him while I was jogging at the stadium's tracks. When I stopped to rest, I noticed that Bolt continued running without stopping to catch his breath. That was when I realised I wanted to train this rare talent.

Bolt was slow but he was determined. Every other student I coached, I had to push them. As for Bolt, he pushed me! He would call me up at 5am and say that he was heading down to the tracks to train. I, of course, had to wipe the sleep out of my eyes and meet him there. I realised that with his determination, he could be the best one day.

One day, Bolt called me up and told me that he had signed himself up for a race. I was shocked. At his speed, he would come in last! When I told him that, he simply chuckled. "That might be true, but at least it will be more challenging than your training, ha ha!" I laughed along.

I trained him as hard as I could. As the days passed, he became better and better. He beat the top runners in my class. I started to use him as a role model for the rest of my students. Eventually, his friends stopped making fun of him. Unfortunately, the day before the race, the most tragic thing happened …

Bolt was hit by a car. His arm was fractured and in a sling. He was supposed to be hospitalised for two days but Bolt refused despite the dull, throbbing pain. He insisted that he went for the race. He said that he did not need his hand to run.

Having no choice (see what I told you about him pushing me), I brought him to the stadium in my car (something I never did for any student before). I bought him an energy drink and got him ready for the race.

He crouched at the starting line and waited for the starter's command. The starter shouted, "Three, two, one…Go!" The race had begun. He followed the technique I had taught him: run slowly and conserve his energy for the final dash.

Would you believe it? He came in second! At the end of the race, Bolt taught me something far greater than anything I have ever taught. He taught me that if you put your mind to it, you can do it. I am sure you all know of someone that you look up to – just remember, they got to where they are because they persevered through their challenges.

By Irfan Primary 5

Topic: Teamwork

Pictures given: A soccer ball, a dragon boat, paintbrush and paint

"Harder!" I shouted to my teammates. We were rowing as fast as we could. "Faster, faster! You can do it!" the other team was way faster than us and it was nearing the finishing line. Suddenly, my teammates started arguing with each other. Our teamwork started to fall apart.

It was a week ago. I was busy at the riverside as usual, practicing rowing as part of my dragon boat co-curricular activity. Suddenly, my coach, Mr Robinson, came up to me.

"Jeren, do you have a moment? I need to talk to you," he said.

We walked over to the shelter.

"Jeren, I want to tell you that you have been selected for the 15th annual dragon boat competition this year along with Aden, Nami, Rias, Ace, Jeff and Amane. Prepare yourselves and do your best. Also, the all-time top champions of Kajio high will be participating in this competition. So be at your best!"

With that, he left. I was pretty shocked. I, a total beginner, was going to compete in a national competition with my seniors? I could not believe it.

The next day arrived and we had a vote to see who would lead the team.

"Ok, based on the votes that we have from everyone, the leader will be…Jeren! Congratulations. You will be the one to decide the outcome of the competition. Good luck to you."

I stood rooted to the ground. I had been chosen as leader? Me? Me?

Aden came over to me and said, "Jeren, so you are our team leader? Well…all I can say is - don't disappoint me and the other seniors.

So now I had a big responsibility on my shoulders. The competition was in one week and I had to practice hard if we were to get our first win in the nationals. But the question was, how? The only experience I had was a rowing practice on land. Land! I had never had an experience with rowing or drumming on a boat before. I was going to lead my seniors! I had a feeling that it would be a pretty tough job.

Luckily, I was given the role of the drummer. I had no strength for rowing!

"Harder! Faster!" I shouted.

It was the 7th practice of the week. We had been practicing near the venue, which was the Sports Hub. There were buoys that were colored in red and blue floating on the river to guide us where our line was. The scenery of Suntec City, Marina Bay Sands, The Esplanade, Gardens by The Bay and other magnificent buildings stood tall at a distance. Beside us were

the OCBC Aquatic Centre and the Kallang Wave Mall, a popular mall in the city area. It was a perfect place for the competition.

On the day of the competition, everyone was raring and ready to go. We did our warm-ups as quickly as we could. Then, we got onto our boat, number 7. Lucky number 7, to be exact. We got into our positions and got ready.

"Positions!" the commentator shouted.

"And…go!" he pulled the trigger and a loud sound filled the air.

I began to hit my drum in a rhythmic manner and my seniors followed my lead. We were in first place for a while until the team from Nanyang Polytechnic overtook us. Soon, we began to slow down. Every team passed us.

Suddenly, Amane shouted, "It's your fault, Jeff!"

"No! It's Nami!"

Everyone began to argue.

Our coordination began to fall apart. We were lagging behind the first boat by almost 50 metres! Now what? I quickly hit the drum several times, as loud as I could to attract everyone's attention. "Stop arguing guys!"

This made everyone keep quiet.

"Do you want to win the race or not? If you want to, then cooperate, please!" I shouted.

They blushed in embarrassment. They started to row again. I heaved a sigh of relief and continued hitting the drum.

We went all out and overtook the other teams. Soon, only the team from Kajio High was ahead of us.

I increased my drumming speed to signal them to row faster. We caught up in just 25 seconds. However, the finish line was 70 meters away!

Who would win? Us? Or Kajio?

We were neck and neck as we crossed the finishing line together. Everyone stopped rowing and cheered.

Later, the organizer showed us a video replay of the competition. When the video neared the end, it showed that we were ahead by just 5cm! I was exhilarated. We had won the nationals!

Everyone went wild. They cheered and screamed, "We won! We won! Hurray for Jeren!" they began to lift me up into the air. I was thrown up like a bouncy, beach ball. I laughed for a moment until I started to get nauseous.

Then I puked.

Everyone steered clear at once. I guess I have sea sickness after all.

Going through this meaningful experience showed me how I could maintain my responsibility as a leader and work together as a team. It was a lesson I would take with me through life.

By Marcus Chan, Primary 6

Topic: Teamwork

Pictures given: A soccer ball, a dragon boat, paintbrush and paint

"No! You're doing it wrongly for god's sake!" my brother, Lee Kai, hollered, before passing me an impatient look. Sighing in exasperation, I snarled at him to shut up. At this rate, I was going to be stuck with an annoying little brat. Just then, the door creaked open and out came…

"John, get out of bed immediately!" my mother ordered me like an army general.

I rubbed my eyes forcefully, trying to stay awake, while a stream of drool trickled down the side of my mouth. Grudgingly, I parted with my bed, as I made my way to the bathroom and changed into my T-shirt and bermudas.

"I want you and Lee Kai to work together to paint the wall in our backyard. Only when you are done can you have breakfast," my mother commanded, before handing us tins of paint and two roller brushes. I sighed. Why did I have to be paired up with the least co-operative person? Why did fate have to be so cruel to me?

On the other hand, Lee Kai was bouncing off the walls thinking that this could finally be a chance to prove to my mother that he was always better than me. Reluctantly, I made my way to the wall at our backyard.

Cobwebs hung at all corners of the wall which was coated with a layer of dust. The wall looked as if it was as old as time itself. I grabbed my roller brush and filled it with paint. Just as I was about to start work, I was interrupted by a babyish voice.

"No! You're doing it wrongly for god's sake!"

Instinctively, I turned around. I rolled my eyes. Great, Lee Kai was trying to be a "smart-alec" again.

"You're so stupid, John. You don't even know how to use a roller brush!" Lee Kai snickered.

Black, molten anger rushed into my brain. I was like a beast waiting to be unleashed. Smoke puffed out of my nostrils as I glared menacingly at Lee Kai, who was now starting work. What have I done wrong? I was holding the roller brush correctly and he even dared to call me, his older brother, an idiot. The more I thought about it, the stronger the raging inferno burned inside me.

Unable to control my anger anymore, I lunged at him, throwing punches at Lee Kai madly. I had enough of his arrogance. Staggering backwards, Lee Kai fell to the ground like a limp rag doll, as excruciating pain radiated throughout his entire being.

Regaining his balance, Lee Kai rewarded me with a swift and hard punch to my stomach. I groaned in agony as I rolled on the floor, clutching my stomach.

Just then, the door creaked open, and out came my mother who heard the commotion. She immediately queried for the details of the incident. Left with no other choice, we told her the truth.

"Boys, you must remember - 'United we stand. Divided we fall.' In order to accomplish anything, we need teamwork."

With that, she ended her speech, before getting us to bury the hatchet and work together as one. We agreed, apologising to each other.

Getting back to work, we decided to stop our quibbling. We helped each other and split our workload evenly. Not long after, we finally accomplished the 'impossible'. We had finished painting the wall!

This freshly-painted wall was a constant reminder to me that one could achieve more if we worked together harmoniously. As Helen Keller always said 'Alone we can do little. Together we can do so much.' We should never underplay the importance of team spirit if we want to achieve more.

By Darren Tan, Primary 6

Topic: An Unexpected Incident

Pictures given: A dog, A skateboard, An open lock

"Woof! Woof!" a dog whizzed past me. I was taking a walk in the park and images of my amazing dog, Clover, started to surface in my mind. I will never forget that day even if I lived to a hundred years old…

"Sarah! Go take Clover out for a stroll in the park!" Mother shouted across the kitchen. Gladly, I grabbed the leash and Clover came running towards me. I attached the leash to Clover and my five-year old sister, Sofia, demanded, "I want to go too!" Soon after that, I was closing the door behind me as we set off for the park.

When we reached the park, there were lots of people, and they reminded me of ants on an anthill. My right hand was holding my sister's and my other hand was holding on to the leash.

"Ring! Ring!" My phone rang.

I shoved my way through the people and found a bench to sit on. I instructed Sofia to stay there, take care of Clover, and wait for me. She nodded. I went to a quieter place to answer the call from a friend.

Few minutes later, I came back and my mouth dropped open.

"Sofia! Where did Clover go?" I boomed.

"Clover was barking so I unleashed him," Sofia answered, looking nonchalant like she had not done anything wrong.

"Ughh!" I grabbed Sofia by the arm and we began our search for Clover.

After fifteen minutes, we still could not find Clover. I was worried sick that something might have happened to him. He had been my companion since I was six.

Suddenly, I heard a familiar barking. "Woof! Woof!" The barking continued. It sounded urgent. My heartbeat quickened and I followed the sound, with Sofia trailing behind. All of a sudden, something caught my eye.

"Clover have you been a good boy?" Sofia said. Clover, however ignored her and continued barking.

When I saw Clover, I was relieved. I then noticed a young boy beside Clover. He had a cut on his leg. Clover was prancing up and down, still barking. I realised that Clover was trying to get attention to help the boy. I decided to bring the boy back to my house to dress the wound. He held onto my arm for support and hobbled back to our house.

"Oh dear, what happened?" Mother inquired upon seeing the limping boy. Sofia and I told her what happened. We fetched the first aid kid. Mother used to be a nurse so she knew how to dress the wound properly.

After she cleaned and bandaged the wound, the boy thanked us profusely. We called a cab to send him home. When the boy was gone, I looked at Clover, feeling a deep sense of pride. I had such a great dog!

By Celeste, Primary 5

Topic: An Unexpected Incident

Pictures given: A dog, A skateboard, An open lock

"Come back! Josh, come back!" Timmy ran after Josh, his dog. Josh dashed across the road. Just then a car appeared and drove down the road at full speed. Timmy watched in horror as Josh ran to the middle of the road, while the car was approaching. A collision was inevitable. He felt like everything was happening in slow-motion before him. "Noooo!" he screamed in horror.

Earlier that day, Timmy and Josh had been walking around the park. It was their holiday routine to go there early at seven o-clock, just as the morning sky was cerulean and the air was fresh. The park was decorated with colourful flowers, tall trees and neatly-trimmed grass. Timmy had seen this beautiful scenery lots of times but he still had not gotten sick of it. He knew where every flower was as he had been there almost every day.

He was holding Josh's leash lightly as he knew that Josh would not run away, even if there were no leash. Josh trotted beside its owner and wagged its tail happily. Josh had a huge grin on his face.

Suddenly, Josh spotted a butterfly. It was yellow and it was fluttering around at Josh's nose. As the butterfly flew away, Josh took off after it. The leash was jerked out of Timmy's hands. Timmy was stunned for a second as he watched his dog run off ahead of him. He chased after Josh.

Josh bounded onto the road, and that was when tragedy struck. A car collided into Josh and sent it flying off a few metres into the air. Timmy screamed. He could not believe that this was happening. He ran toward Josh, who was now lying motionlessly on the road. The driver came out, apologising profusely.

"I am sorry I killed your dog," the driver said.

"No he is not dead!" Timmy cried out. "He has just passed out from his head injury!"

Realising that Timmy was not going to accept the facts, the driver offered to bring Josh to a vet nearby. Timmy cradled the lifeless body of Josh and climbed into the car.

When they got to the vet's the doctors declared that Josh was already dead. Timmy cried uncontrollably. The driver tried his best to console him and offered to pay for the pet burial service that the vet recommended. Timmy continued wailing as the driver led him back to the car to send him home.

That day, Timmy realised that sometimes, whether you like it or not, the unexpected happens. He had no choice but to accept Josh's death.

By Ying Xuan, Primary 5

Topic: An Act of Kindness

Pictures given: An old lady, An MRT train, "Priority Seat" sign

It had been a long day at work. Finally, the train roared into the station and swarms of people gushed inside as soon as the doors opened. Much to my dismay, the train was packed with commuters who were literally breathing down one another's necks. I managed to shuffle into a little standing space in the corner of the overloaded train just a mere second before the doors closed.

Placing a hand on my forehead, I sighed wearily. I was feeling feverish and the throbbing pain in my head would not cease. I hoped I would be able to reach home in time to take my medication. Suddenly, a soft voice broke my train of thoughts.

"Would you like to buy some lollipops?" a frail old lady asked, holding out a plastic bag full of lollipops.

Her figure was hunchbacked and shriveled. Her white hair framed her wrinkled face and purple veins were visibly extended across it like a map of a thousand railway tracks. With a tinge of annoyance in my voice, I refused adamantly.

"Get lost!" I snapped.

The septuagenarian cast her dim eyes down in sorrow and turned to others instead.

As the train continued its arduous journey ahead, the pain in my head intensified and I began gasping for air. Oh, the pain! Without warning, my vision blurred; the people around me seemed to swirl around… I lost my balance and in a blur, I fell onto the ground. Thud! Groaning in sheer pain, I tried to get to my feet but to no avail. My thread of consciousness was slipping away… But no one even bothered to come forward and help me. They gave me no more than a cursory glance. How horrible! What a cold-blooded world! Tears of anguish and agony welled up in my eyes.

"Are you alright?" a compassionate and soothing voice called out.

Then, I felt a pair of feeble arms encasing me and helping me up to my feet. Curious, I turned to see who the Good Samaritan was. Were my eyes playing tricks on me? It was the old lady who tried to sell me lollipops! Before I could react, she fished out a bottle of medicated oil from her plastic bag and rubbed the oil on my temples tenderly. A soothing sensation swept over me and I felt better instantly.

A twinge of guilt jabbed me on the inside. Although I had treated her badly earlier, her kindness prevailed and decided to lend me a helping hand. It dawned upon me that I was part of this cold-blooded world. I thanked the old lady copiously, my eyes watery with tears. They were tears of both gratitude and remorse. The guilt engulfing me was unbearable and I decided to buy some lollipops from her. Her once dim eyes lit up with delight, and she handed me some lollipops and clutched the money in her trembling hands.

"Thank you, young lady! God bless!" she flashed me a toothy grin and alighted the train.

That night, I hobbled home, a transformed soul. I realized that the world would be a heart-warming place if there were more Good Samaritans like that old lady. I also made a promise to show more compassion to the people around me and never again, to ignore a person in need. Kindness can indeed change the world.

By Kevin, Primary 6

Topic: Being Kind

Pictures given: A plaster, A wheelchair, Baby birds in a nest

The train was bustling with many commuters. Most of them were heading for work. Uncle Tan was on his wheelchair and trying to make his way through the train door. He had sunken cheeks and wrinkles on his pale-looking face. He was heading to Tan Tock Seng Hospital for his regular check-up. The train was packed like sardines and nobody could move much.

At the next stop, Uncle Tan exited from the train and slowly rolled the wheels of the wheelchair to the nearest lift. This was the first time for Uncle Tan had to travel on his own as his son would usually send him before heading to work. As he came out from the lift, he heard loud screeching noises made by his wheelchair. He knew something was not right but still kept moving. Suddenly, the right wheel of his wheelchair became loose and came off! Uncle Tan could not balance himself and fell to the ground with a loud thud. He was groaning in pain and he sustained a few minor cuts on his left arm. Panic engulfed him and he did not know what to do.

"Help…someone please help me!"

A young teenager saw him on the ground and rushed over immediately.

"Are you alright, uncle?" the teenager asked repeatedly.

Uncle Tan nodded his head with teary eyes. The teenager quickly fixed the wheel back onto Uncle Tan's wheelchair and asked Uncle Tan where he was heading. He then offered to accompany Uncle Tan to the hospital. Uncle Tan was astonished by how the teenager treated him so nicely. In Uncle Tan's heart, the teenager was the kindest person that he had ever encountered in his life.

Soon, they arrived at the hospital.

Uncle Tan grabbed the teenager's hands and with tears of appreciation in his eyes, said, "You are a caring person indeed and I appreciate what you have done for me."

Till today, Uncle Tan could still remember the kind and caring teenager.

By Haziq, Primary 6

Topic: Helping Someone Out

Pictures given: A wallet, A Crying boy, a "For Disabled" toilet sign

"Thank you! Thank you very much!" John thanked me profusely as soon as I handed the wallet back to him. I felt a surge of guilt. I did not deserve his gratitude…

Earlier that day, I was walking past the void deck when I heard the faint wailing sound of a child. It grew louder as I got closer to the source.

"Who's that crying? Is somebody hurt?" I thought, looking around.

Just then, I spotted a familiar figure bending over a drain. The child noticed me and looked up. Upon closer inspection, I recognised him as my mischievous, young neighbour, John.

I had never really liked John. In fact, I hate him! He was always up to no good. Just last week, John destroyed a painting that I had left outside my house to dry.

"What's wrong?" I asked hesitantly.

"My wallet fell through the drain cover. There is no way I can get it out through this grills…" John explained between sobs. "Can…can you help me get it?"

"Why should I help you? You once threw my homework into a puddle of water!" I replied coldly and walked away, secretly feeling happy over John's misery.

"Okay…" John murmured as he looked down, ashamed, tears still rolling down his eyes.

I went to the shopping centre nearby to buy some books and stationery. When I walked back home, I passed by the same drain where John's wallet had fallen through. My conscience was prickling.

"Was I too harsh? I guess I was," I thought as I looked down at the wallet that was still lying there pathetically. I found two twigs nearby and stuck them through the grills of

the drain. I used them like a pair of tongs to life the wallet up. Unfortunately it was not as easy as I expected. The wallet kept falling off again and again. I tried and failed several times.

"Yes finally!" I exclaimed as I finally lifted the wet, dripping wallet out from the drain.

I went to return the wallet back to John. He was still weeping outside his house.

"I am sorry for being so harsh earlier. Here's your wallet," I said.

His eyes lit up and he thanked me profusely.

Although I returned the wallet in the end, I still could not help but feel ashamed of my earlier actions. I should not have been so rude to John; he was only six. I should not have been so mean. I ought to always lend a helping hand in a time of need.

By Megan Ng, Primary 6

Topic: Charity

Pictures given: A donation tin, Children organising a food drive, A car wash

"Sarah, you are going to collect donations outside Hougang MRT station."

It was during the June holidays. Sarah was helping the near-by old folk's home to raise funds. She had just been told where to stand for flag day. Sarah thought, "This is going to be easy-peasy!" She collected her tin and put in in her knapsack. As the old folks home was in Upper Serangoon, she had to take a bus to the train station.

When she reached the station, she took out her tin and then placed her bag on the ground. Filled with confidence, she walked towards a man. She tapped the man on the shoulder and he turned around. She wanted to ask the man if he could donate to the old folks home, but instead, the words that came out from her mouth were, " C-c-could… y-y-you… ple-please…"

The man just stared at her and raised an eyebrow. Then he walked away.

"This is harder than I thought!" Sarah muttered to herself.

She went up to another passer-by. The same thing happened to her. She tried again and again, but every time she found herself tongue-tied.

Hours flew by. Before Sarah knew it, it was already three o'clock in the afternoon. She had only two more hours to go and she still did not have a single cent in the tin.

She said to herself, "You have to do this for the sake of the old folk's home!"

She mustered all her courage as she walked towards a kind-looking man.

"S-s-s-sir, w-w-would you mind d-d-dona-donating some… m-m-money?" she stuttered, trying her best to look confident.

She did not want to make a fool of herself yet again. The man put his hand in his pocket. He found some loose change. He took it out, and put it into the tin. The clinking of coins could be heard. Sarah smiled at the man. She then went towards a lady and did the same thing. The lady too, donated the money.

As minutes went by, the tin got heavier and heavier. She needed to hold it with both hands now.

Two hours went by. Sarah took a taxi back to the old folk's home. The lady smiled at her and took the tin. She poured out all the coins and notes on a table.

She said, "Go play with the rest while I count. I will tell you the total amount later."

Sarah went to find her friends and they played "Snap".

After a while the lady came in and said, “Children, I have good news. Sarah, you’ve got more than $200! Alex, you have…” she continued to tell all of them what they had got.

“We have raised a total of $10,000!” she announced happily.

Everyone started clapping. They were so excited. Sarah went home and told her mother the good news. Her mother praised her. Sarah felt a sense of accomplishment that day. She vowed to take part in as many charity events in the future.

By Ying Xuan, Primary 5

Topic: Charity

Pictures given: A donation tin, Children organising a food drive, A car wash

I was getting annoyed. Many people were getting irritated and were driving away in their cars. The sponges, pails and Rachel, were not here yet.

"Come on Rachel! Hurry up and get here!" I murmured.

Our car wash time had already started yet Rachel had still not shown up.

It was the school holidays and I had nothing to do. Normally, I would enjoy the school holidays and just relax. However, this was the first time I had felt so bored. Then, I had an idea. I wanted to do something for charity. I did not have much savings but I could wash cars. I smiled to myself as I imagined myself giving lots of money to charity. However, I would need some help.

I emailed my friends, Rachel and Alice. They sounded keen by their responses. I informed them of the date of the car wash and told Rachel to bring the sponges and pails she had at home.

Now here I was, grumbling about Rachel. Alice stood beside me quietly. She hated talking about other people behind their backs.

"Rachel, come on! Many cars are leaving and we are losing lots of business!" I grumbled again.

What if I could not make any money? What If I could donate only a few dollars? What if I only made five or six dollars? I was horrified at the thought of me donating so little money. I wanted to donate a huge sum to charity but it was all being spoilt by Rachel's unpunctuality.

"Hey! Why not text Rachel? We can't afford to lose any more cars. Look!" Alice suggested. I smacked my forehead. It was so obvious! I immediately took out my phone and texted Rachel. Not long after, I saw a "read" sign beside my message. That meant that Rachel had read the message.

After a few minutes, Rachel came down with pails and sponges. "What took you…" but before I could start shouting at Rachel, Alice interrupted, "Save it for later. We have some work to do."

I glared at Alice. How could she butt in when I was about to scold Rachel. However, the sound of the horns of the cars reminded me of the urgent matter on hand. I nodded my head and got to work.

Before long, we finished with all the car washing. It was harder than we thought. We were utterly exhausted but immensely satisfied with the results. I rattled the coins in the box we had used for keeping money.

"$205!" I counted.

It was better than I had expected. Later, I found out that I had sent the wrong date to Rachel by mistake. I felt my face go red and blushed while apologising to Rachel. Being forgiving, Rachel did not dwell on the matter but instead talked about what a great job we had done.

Charity was hard work, but it was fun and definitely worth it.

By Natalie Chua, Primary 6

Topic: Overcoming Fear

Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage

"And that's 'The Ray of Hope' for you!" Asta said as she ended her book review.

She took a deep bow and was given a thundering applause. I, too, gave an applause. I was happy for my friend. Well, I was pretending to be happy for her. Deep down inside, I was rather feeling envious of Asta. She was always the one who makes speeches, debates and tell stories to others. Me? No! I had stage fright and was always the shy, quiet one who was never courageous to speak in front of others. I always kept to myself. I had never managed to do a presentation without stuttering. Every time I saw someone making a speech, I would imagine myself in his or her place, receiving the applause and praise. If only, one day, I could bring myself to muster up the courage to present to someone. I had had enough of this shyness and silence.

I was walking to the canteen with Asta. She, as usual, was looking at the script. She had been chosen to be the emcee for the National Day Celebration. I sighed to myself. Why could I not be like her, always loud and brave? If only there was a way to prove myself…

Just then, as if God had heard me, I caught a glimpse of a poster on the noticeboard.

"Minute to say it?" I read the poster out loud.

It was a competition where one has to prepare a speech about a particular topic and summarise it on the stage within one minute. This could be my big chance to overcome my stage fright! And the best part was, if I won the competition, I would receive a mini-trophy.

Without thinking twice, I grabbed a form and filled it. Tossing it into the sign-up box, I thought about the topic of the speech. I took a seat in the canteen with Asta and told her what I had done, after which she also said that she had also signed up for the competition. Suddenly, regret hit me like a 20-pound sledgehammer. I was competing against Asta who was the best speaker in the school! I was sure to be doomed! I was bound to lose! Why was I so ill-fated? I just wanted a chance to prove myself that I could overcome my stage fright. I wished I could rewind time.

However, if I could win against Asta, I would be recognised by many! It was going to be a challenge.

The competition was about a day away. I had picked my topic and had begun practising. I timed myself to say the speech in one minute. No room for mistakes. If I were to stutter on the actual day, I would lose all the time! Moreover, the speech should not be too vague. "No more negative thoughts, Sophia! You can do this!" I encouraged myself.

The big day finally arrived. Many students were backstage, all nervous and jittery. Time seemed to pass very quickly as the first few contestants made their way to the stage. Soon enough, it was my turn. As I staggered on the stage, my legs turned to jelly.

"Sophia, your time starts now!" the judge announced as she started her stopwatch.

"This…is…is…my…" I began.

No! No more stammering, Sophia! You can do this! With forty seconds left, I went through the rest of my speech eloquently. The moment the stopwatch clicked stop, I heaved a huge sigh of relief. I had three seconds to spare.

Next, it was Asta's turn. Her speech was so brilliant that even I was captivated! Later, at the prize ceremony, Asta was made champion while I got second place. Although I did not win Asta, I was more than elated to come in second. At least I had something to take home to show my parents.

Hmmm… Come to think of it…Maybe overcoming my fear was not so bad after all!

By Ajay, Primary 6

Topic: Overcoming Fear

Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage

Every time I see that shiny, gold trophy, it would remind me of how my mother's encouragement had gotten me to where I was now…

"You can do it! I know you can!" my mother encouraged me before going onto the stage. I could not help but return her a weak smile. I was forced to participate in this singing competition by my parents. I did not want to do so at first, as I feared for the worst. The minute I stepped onto the stage, a hundred pair of eyes bored into me.

As I introduced myself to the judges, I stammered incoherently. I looked at my mother and saw a huge smile plastered on her face as she gave me a nod of encouragement. Before I started to sing, I whispered a silent prayer. Slowly breathing in and out, I closed my eyes and started singing. As I sang, I could hear murmurs from the crowd and the judges. I continued singing without caring what others thought about me.

After ending my song, there was complete silence. Did I do something wrong? Did I sing my lyrics correctly? Did they think my singing was bad? All sorts of thoughts ran through my mind. Suddenly, a roaring applause thundered across the whole auditorium. My heard raced as a little hope sparked inside me. I looked at the judges and did not expect the looks on their faces. Their jaws were dropped and they were wide-eyed.

"Wow…just wow…" one of them finally said.

As I received the trophy, I beamed with pride. I was glad that I had listened to my parents.

"Naomi! Your new album is out!" my manager screamed excitedly. As I put down the trophy, I made a mental note to myself. I will never give in to fear so easily.

By Naomi Rai, Primary 6

Topic: Overcoming Fear

Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage

I dropped my microphone. It let out a loud whine as it hit the floor. The audience started to whisper and talk. I even heard someone shout, "Terrible!" I trembled like jelly. I totally regretted what I had said to my form teacher that day.

Earlier that week, I was having my music lesson. When I was singing in the classroom with the other classmates, the music teacher passed by and thought that I had a talent for singing. She asked whether I wanted to perform on stage for the Teacher's Day performance. I thought it would be awesome to show the school that I could sing well. I nodded my head and agreed to sing.

I practised every day because of the performance. I practised so hard that I hardly even do my homework. In school, my teachers scolded me as I did not hand in my homework. My friends, even my best ones, told me that I should not sing in front of the whole school as I was too timid and frightened. I did not heed their advice as I believed that I would be successful.

I always remember "practice makes perfect". I wanted to show my friends that I could do it. Soon, it was the Teacher's day celebration. I was so proud to sing to the school.

After the Lion dance and the Chinese dance, it would be my turn to perform. I started panicking. I was gasping for air. I was too timid. I went to find my music teacher who saw that I was trembling. He told me to calm down and said that everything would be find after I started singing the song. My friends were right. I was just a scaredy-cat. I have not even gone up on stage and I was already panicking!

"Next, let us clap for Chloe to come up on stage and sing us a song!" the emcee announced.

When I walked up the stage, the audience was clapping and watching me. I trembled like jelly. There were like a hundred pairs of eyes boring into me. How could I even sing? There are so many pairs of eyes staring at me! I think I have a lump in my throat!

All of a sudden, I dropped the microphone and it whined. I look to my music teacher in desperation. He just smiled and gave me a thumbs up. I mustered up all my courage and sang.

Although I did not sing as well as when I was practising, I still put in my best effort. After I finished the song, I felt like a huge weight have been lifted off my shoulders. My friends cheered for me. I also showed that I could do it. Next time, I would take a deep breath and sing with the belief that I could overcome all challenges!

By Charmaine Khoo, Primary 6

Topic: Overcoming Fear

Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage

"Thud!" I laid spread eagled on the floor. All eyes were on me. Flushing hotly, I struggled to stand up. With embarrassment staining my face, I wished that this misery would end soon.

Earlier on, I was at the back stage. It was the day of "Rosyth Got Talent" competition. My English teacher, Mrs Ng, had selected me to represent our class. She was also the school's discipline mistress and always put on a brusque voice when speaking. It was unimaginable of me to utter a squeak of protest when I was chosen. Scanning around the area, I saw my fellow school mates closing their eyes, trying to memorise the scripts that they had prepared. A buzz of nervous energy was in the air. I could feel pressure building upon me. My face was tight with tension as I clenched and unclenched my fists. I knew that it was going to be a nightmare for me.

Deep down, I had a phobia of being on stage and did not dare to speak in front of a group of audience. I had once spoken publicly in front of a huge audience and it turned out to be horrible. From then on, I promised not to do that again.

"Hey Tim!" a voice came from behind, jolting me out of my thoughts.

It was Jerry, my best friend.

"Do your best and remember to take in deep breaths! I know you can do it!" Jerry's encouraging words made me gain a little confidence.

Then, I started shuffling through my script and read them out to myself. At the same time, my heart was thumping wildly. Just when I was worried that I would be called up, Mrs Ng came in and told me to get ready to go on stage. Upon hearing that, I smiled weakly at her. I could feel butterflies in my stomach. I wished this ordeal would end soon.

"Let's invite our next speaker Tim Lim!" the emcee announced.

Taking a deep breath, I trudged up the stage and found myself facing hundreds of people. Finally, I was in the middle of the stage. The applause had now died down and there was pin- drop silence in the air. I could feel hundred pairs of eyes piercing into my soul. My hands were clammy and my lips quivered. I stood there helplessly as fear took control of my entire being.

All of a sudden, I felt the hall began to whirl. Just then, my eye caught sight of a friendly face in the crowd. It was Jerry. He was smiling at me and giving me a thumbs-up sign.

Mustering all my courage, I took a deep breath and began, "Good morning Teachers and Friends…"

Then, I paused abruptly. To my horror, I realized that my mind was in a blank. I could not remember my script. I shuddered in fear, not knowing what to do. I started retreating backwards. Suddenly I tripped on the wire of the microphone and fell face first onto the ground with a loud thud.

" Ahh…" I grimaced in pain. At the same time, the microphone dropped and hit the ground, producing a loud annoying sound. The audiences quickly covered their ears and looked pissed off. Flushing hotly, I stood up. My face was as red as a beetroot. I told myself that I had to overcome my fear. I had to. I picked up the microphone from the floor and started speaking.

Finally, after what seemed like an eternity, my speech came to an end. As I made my way down the stage, I heaved a sigh of relief. I could hardly believe that I had managed to complete my speech. Jerry quickly rushed up to me and gave me a hi-five and chirped, "See, I told you, you can do it!" A sense of pride beamed in me.

An hour later, the results were announced. Expectantly, I did not win but it did not matter to me at all. I was elated that I had managed to overcome the challenge of stage fright and conquered my fears to do what I thought was impossible.

By Braedon, Primary 6

Topic: Overcoming Fear

Pictures given: A microphone, A piano, A stage

"Find someone else, please… I can't do this," Sally pleaded her teacher, Mrs Lee.

"But we can't find anyone else, you are the best," Mrs Lee replied.

Sally was getting more nervous every second. She was supposed to play the piano while Rachel was going to sing. When Mrs Lee was choosing some students to perform for the Teacher's Day concert, Sally was confident of playing the piano. It seemed like a bad idea now.

Sally peered out of the curtains and let out a tiny scream. She came to the hall for assembly every week. It always felt small and cosy. However, now as she looked out from the stage, she could see hundreds of people staring back at her. She hurriedly retreated to the backstage.

Rachel saw the expression on Sally's face and comforted her. It was obvious that Sally was suffering from stage fright. Rachel herself had experienced stage fright. At that moment, Mrs Lee announced, "Here comes Sally who will be playing the piano and Rachel who will be singing!" There was a roaring applause from the teachers and students. Sally was shaking like a leaf and her legs almost gave way as she made her way to the stage. Rachel looked at Sally and gave her a nod of encouragement. She squeezed Sally's hands which felt cold and clammy.

The moment Sally and Rachel stepped on the stage, the spotlight immediately, greeted them. The entire hall was decorated with balloons of different colours and there were spotlights changing colours and shining everywhere. The audience were whispering excitedly.

A lump was starting to form in Sally's throat. The colour of her face drained completely. Hundreds of eyes were glued onto her. When Sally sat on the chair, the notes that she was supposed to play were washed clean off her memory.

"Rachel, help me! I've forgotten some of the notes!" Sally whispered frantically.

"Don't worry, Sally. Play the first few notes and it will all come back to you. Trust me," Rachel smiled at her. Sally did not really believe her but she was so desperate she clung on to every single word.

When the music started, Sally played the first few notes uncomfortably. True enough, the notes came back into her mind. Soon, the entire hall was filled with the melody of Sally's piano and Rachel's singing.

The performance ended and everyone in the school clapped louder for them than the rest of the other performances. Sally thanked Rachel for helping her on stage. Without Rachel, Sally felt that she could not have done it.

The performance made Sally overcome her stage fright. From then on, it was always a joy for Mrs Lee to have Sally and Rachel perform on stage for any special events.

By Natalie Chua, Primary 6

Topic: First Day in School

Pictures given: A bus, Children raising their hands, A boy clutching his stomach

Sam spoke with a stammer. Despite his condition, he was an outgoing boy and was never afraid to try new things. He strongly believed that when there is a will, there is a way.

Finally, the day for him to attend primary school arrived. He was a little worried and afraid but he did not let his feelings affect his positive learning attitude. As he entered the school gate of Flora Primary School, the hustle and bustle of the school greeted him. Students in the canteen were either munching away on their finger-licking food or talking nineteen to a dozen.

Soon, the school bell rang and it was time for the students to return to their respective classes. Peace was restored in the canteen as the students left one by one. On Sam's way back to class, he met the principal, Mr. Teo.

"Have a great first day in school, Sam! I am sure you will have lots of fun here," wished Mr. Teo.

He gave a reassuring pat on Sam's back. The pat was all he needed to calm himself down as he felt he was ready to face the other students belonging to the same class as him.

In no time, the students of Sam's class were back in their comfortable seats. Sam was asked to introduce himself.

"Bu…but Mrs. Ta…Tan, I spe…speak wi…with a stam…stammer. The oth…other pup…pupils will defin…definitely ma…make fu…fun of m…me," Sam stammered as an immense surge of panic and worry began to set in him.

"I'm sure they will understand your condition. Just go ahead and take your time," Mrs. Tan assured him as a smile appeared on her face.

Beads of cold sweat formed on Sam's forehead as he introduced himself to the class. It was terrifying. Forty pairs of eyes were glued onto him when he began his speech.

"Calm down Sam, calm down," a voice broke out. Phew! It was just Mrs. Tan.

At this juncture, he was already trembling like a leaf.

"Ha ha! Ha ha! Big baby Sam needs a teacher to calm him down and speaks with such a weird stammer. He should go back to preschool and learn how to speak," a few boys who were a little too tall for their age started to jeer at him.

Upon hearing that, the entire class except Tom erupted into peals of laughter.

Tom was the only boy sitting in the front row with thick nerdy glasses. He empathised with Sam's condition. Tears welled up in Sam's eyes at this very moment while the rest of the

class continued laughing hysterically. Overcome by shame, Sam scurried back to his seat, clutching a piece of napkin in his right hand.

Instantly, Tom walked towards Sam and comforted him, “Don’t worry Sam. I understand your condition. This class does not have respect at all.”

After which, he put his arm around Sam’s shoulder.

Thud!

The sound emitted by Mrs. Tan when she slammed the dictionary on the table ricocheted throughout the entire classroom. It scared the living daylights out of everyone and silence was restored before Mrs. Tan went ballistic. She reprimanded the class for jeering at Sam. With their heads hung low in extreme shame, the boys apologized vehemently to Sam. Sam accepted their apology as he disliked holding grudges on people. That day after lessons, he chanced upon Mrs. Tan as he made his way towards the school gate.

She smiled at him and began, “Sam, I know of your condition, my own son suffers from it too. Just take your time to learn. Approach me if you require any additional coaching, I would be more than pleased to help.”

Sam replied obligingly, “I…I… will Mrs. Tan, I will p-p-put in all my effort. T-t-hank you for your unwavering faith in m-m-me.”

From that day onwards, the class refrained from making fun of anyone as they did not want to get detention and another one of those tongue-lashings from their very fierce form teacher.

By Melissa Liew, Primary 6

Topic: Resilience

Pictures given: A running track, A glass of water, A light bulb

"Loser!"John's voice kept ringing in my mind like a broken record.

I regretted signing up for the race. I was a slow runner and it did not help that I was plump as well. Whenever I ran, my stomach would get in the way by bouncing and wobbling. Because of that, John always called me a loser.

I resolved to become fit and even signed up for a 1600 metre race for Sports Day to challenge myself . I decided to run every morning from my house to the nearby park, and then back home. I also changed my diet. I started eating more vegetables and stopped eating snacks and fast food. At first, these changes felt difficult but soon, when I saw my tummy becoming slimmer, I felt much better!

Soon, Sports Day arrived. I was determined to win this race.

It is now or never, I thought.

When I stepped into the stadium, butterflies fluttered in my stomach. My heart pumped fast. All eyes were glued on me as I was the only plump racer in this competition. I felt embarrassed to death. I suddenly wished I could vanish into thin air.

"Your attention please. Would the runners of the 1600 metre race gather at the starting point now?"

I walked to the starting line. I saw my friend, Tom, who gave me a nod of encouragement. My heart was still beating wildly but I felt braver.

I looked to my left, and there was John.

"Loser you will never win this race!" John glared at me.

His arrogance stank. I was determined to prove him wrong. These few months of training would not be a waste.

"On your marks, get set…"

Bang!

The starter gun was so loud that my ears rang for a few seconds. Adrenaline rushed through my veins. This was the moment I had been waiting for,

The runners hurtled forward. Everyone took big strides. At first, I was lagging behind. But determination filled my heart and propelled me forward. I opened my strides and ran like there was no tomorrow. My muscles ached. My soles burned. My blood pumped madly in my veins.

I was a speed demon. I was truly unstoppable. The spectators went berserk. They all stood up and cheered for me. The scene that unfolded before their eyes was astonishing – this plump boy was catching up fast from behind!

I could not afford to disappoint them. I could not let myself down. I overtook the runners one by one and finally came side-by-side with John.

I pushed myself even harder; I was now first in the race. My feet pounded the tracks. I was not contented with just winning. It had to be a wide gap. I had to be a clear winner. It had to be a new record time!

My heart pounded like a drum as I sprinted at the last fifty metres. Perspiration tricked down my forehead like a drizzle.

Snap!

I crossed the finish line. The grandstand was filled with the frenzied roar of the spectators. My resilience had finally paid off.

By Bryan Teh, Primary 6

Some Final Words

Dear Parent,

The question I get asked most of the time is "How can my child improve his or her English and Writing skills?"

To which, the answer I give is so clichéd that you've probably heard it a zillion times. "Read. Read. Read."

Read magazines, articles, storybooks, comprehension passages, comic books, newspapers… anything! If you can cultivate a reading habit in your child, the battle is more than half-won.

Although everyone knows this advice, very few parents or students actually do it. There will be lots of excuses to explain why 'reading' cannot be carried out by their children or within their households. And I totally understand. A friend once told me this: "The simplest advice is often the hardest to follow."

Now think about that statement. If you want to be slim, you have to eat less and exercise more. If you want to be rich, you have to spend less and earn more. If you want good grades, you need to play less and study more. And if you want to get good in English or Writing… read more **and** write more!

But simple advice is boring. Simple advice is often tedious. Simple advice seems… all too simple…

Now reading has more benefits than just improving English or your child's writing skills.

It can help to train focus. It provides you and your child with more knowledge. (Notice how all the smart and successful people tend to be voracious readers?) Reading can bring you to places you've never been to, expand your worldview, and help you to think critically on certain issues. It can also give you fresh ideas to tackle problems that you may be facing in life. Reading is also good entertainment.

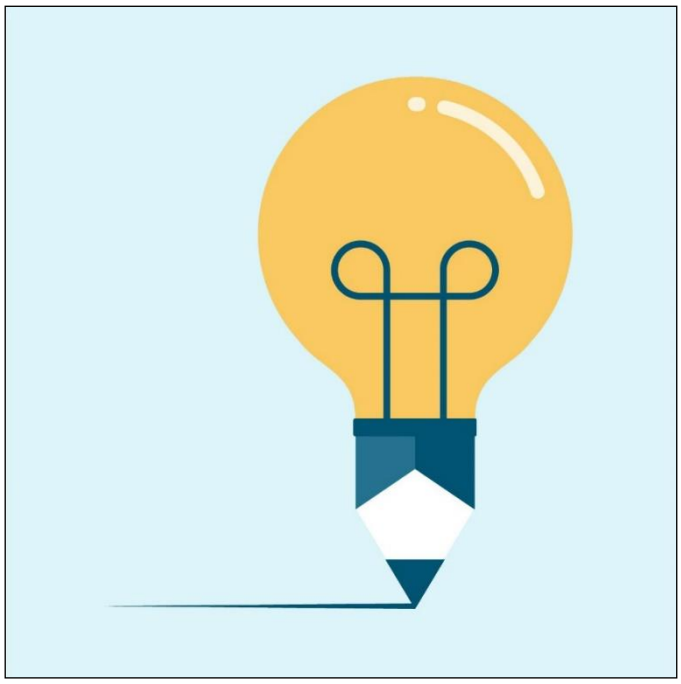
So if you really want your child to improve in English, get him or her to read more… and maybe write more. Of course it would be best if you could lead by example!

Hope you found this ebook useful! Stay tuned for version 2!

Cheers,

Jerry Lee

You might find these online courses helpful!



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